

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 611

By Bowling

A RESOLUTION to recognize the National Day of Prayer.

WHEREAS, the National Day of Prayer is a long-standing tradition observed annually on the first Thursday in May, as established by joint resolution of the United States Congress in 1952 (66 Stat. 65) and amended in 1988 (102 Stat. 468); and

WHEREAS, the president of the United States has issued an annual proclamation designating the first Thursday in May as the National Day of Prayer, calling upon Americans of all faiths and backgrounds to engage in voluntary prayer, meditation, or reflection; and

WHEREAS, prayer and spiritual reflection have played a significant role in the history and culture of this State and the United States since its founding; and

WHEREAS, this State has a compelling interest in acknowledging and preserving its historical and cultural heritage while respecting the religious freedom of all citizens; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that the first Thursday in May of each year is hereby designated as "National Day of Prayer" in this State.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the governor shall annually issue a proclamation:

- (1) Recognizing the National Day of Prayer;
- (2) Encouraging citizens, consistent with their individual beliefs, to engage in prayer, meditation, or personal reflection on that day;
- (3) Calling for voluntary participation by residents, community organizations, and faith-based groups in observances that respect the diversity of religious expression in this State; and

(4) Inviting local governments, schools, and civic organizations to acknowledge the day in a manner consistent with the First Amendment to the United States Constitution.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.